H-B-00101b (GSA-FSS)
October 10, 1968
INTERIM REVISION OF
Fed. Spec. H-B-101a
February 13, 1951

INTERIM FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

BROOM, WHISK

This Interim Federal Specification was developed by the Standardization Division, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, Washington, D.C. 20405, based upon currently available technical information. It is recommended that Federal Agencies use it in procurement and forward recommendations for changes to the preparing activity at the address shown above.

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Interim Federal Specification as a valid exception to Federal Specification H-B-101a, dated February 13, 1951.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers requirements for whisk brooms, primarily intended for use in sweeping up small amounts of trash and dust in and around furniture, closets and regular private size motor vehicles.

1.2 Classification. Unless otherwise specified, whisk brooms covered by this specification shall be of one type, class and size. (See figure 1).

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Specifications and standards. The following specifications and standards of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specifications:

T-T-881 - Twine, Cotton Seine.
T-T-891 - Twine, Linen.
T-T-911 - Twine, Jute.
QQ-N-290 - Nickel Plating, (Electrodeposited).
QQ-P-416 - Plating, Cadmium (Electrodeposited).
QQ-Z-325 - Zinc Coating, Electrodeposited, Requirements For.
PPP-B-636 - Box, Fiberboard.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking For Domestic Shipment (Civilian Agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cummulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D.C. 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D.C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, Wash.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:06Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105
MIL-STD-129

(Copies of Military Specification and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Preproduction sample. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.1) before production is commenced, a sample of the broom to be supplied shall be submitted or made available to the contracting officer or his authorized representative for examination and approval in accordance with 4.2. Approval of the preproduction sample authorizes commencement of production but does not relieve the supplier of responsibility for compliance with all applicable provisions of this specification. The preproduction sample shall be manufactured in the same facilities to be used for the manufacture of the production items.

3.2 Illustration. The illustration shown in figure 1, is for the purpose of illustrating general design and is not to preclude the purchase of items which are otherwise in accordance with the requirements of this specification.

3.3 Material.

3.3.1 Broom corn. The body of the whisk broom shall be made from "A" quality broom corn which is green or pale green in color, with no flat fiber, and free from all objectionable differences.

3.3.2 Handle. The handle shall be of the same quality broom corn as the body. There shall be a wooden core in the handle extending at least one inch into the body of the broom. The diameter of the core shall be a minimum of 1/4 inch. The handle shall be well wound with 0.032 inch diameter broom wire. Black steel wire or wire coated to resist corrosion shall be used. Coating shall be either Cadmium in accordance with Type III, Class C of QQ-P-416 of Zinc in accordance with Type III, Class 3 of QQ-Z-325 and shall show no evidence of corrosion when tested as described in 4.4.2.

3.3.2.1 Ball-cap and ring. The handle shall be topped with a ball-cap and ring attached at the hand end. The ball-cap and ring shall have an aluminum cap with a nickel plated steel ring or a nickel plated steel ball-cap and ring. The nickel plated coating shall be in accordance with Type FS, Classes 1 or 2 of QQ-N-290, and shall show no evidence of corrosion when tested as described in 4.4.2.

3.3.3 Stitching. The broom shall be held firmly in shape by twine having a breaking strength of not less than 25 pounds when tested in accordance with 4.4.1.

3.3.3.1 Twine. The twine shall be one of the following materials.

	Material	Minimum Length Per Pound (feet)
T-T-881	Twine, Cotton, Seine Commercial size 18, 6 ply	1020
T-T-891	Twine, Linen Type II, 3 ply	2280
T-T-911	Twine, Jute Type II, Size 1, 2 ply	1620

3.4 Physical requirements. The whisk brooms shall conform to the minimum physical requirements in table I.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:06Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE I. Physical requirements

Characteristics	Dimensions
Overall Length Inches	10
Broom body:	
Length----------Inches	7
Width across stitching do	3
Handle:	
Length---------- do	2-1/2
Winding:	
Number of wire heads[1]---	2
Total number of wire strands[2]	7
Stitching:	
Number of rows	2
Number of stitches per row	8
Distance between rows _Inches	3/8
Weight:	
Per dozen----------Pounds	3-1/2

[1] "Bead" is that portion of the handle between two rings of wire. A ring of wire is several wraps of wire.

[2] The end wires shall be wound at least 1/8 inch from the end of the handle, and securely held in place by one or more tacks or staples to prevent wire from slipping off st the end.

3.5 Workmanship. The finished broom shall conform to the quality and grade of product established by this specification and the occurance of defects shall not exceed the applicable acceptable quality levels and they shall be free from defects which affect their appearance or which may affect their serviceability.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS.

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to the prescribed requirements.

4.2 Preproduction sample inspection. The preproduction sample shall be examined for defects in 4.3.2.

4.3 Sampling for inspection and acceptance. Sampling for inspection and acceptance shall be performed in accordance with the provisions set forth in MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated.

4.3.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1 above, the supplier is responsible for insuring that components and material used are manufactured, tested and inspected to insure conformance with the requirements of this specification.

4.3.2 End item inspection. Examination of the end item shall be in accordance with the classifications of defects, inspection levels and acceptable quality levels set forth below. The lot size for the purpose of determining the sample size in accordance with MIL-STD-105, shall be expressed in units of brooms for inspection under 4.3.2.1.

4.3.2.1 Visual examination of the end item for defects in appearance, construction, dimension, and workmanship. The inspection level shall be S-2 with an acceptable quality level of 2.5. The sample unit for this examination shall be one broom.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:06Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE II. Visual and dimensional examination.

Examine	Defects
Material	
Ball-cap & Ring	Any sign of corrosion.
Broom corn	Not "A" Quality. Color other than green or pale green. Flat fiber used.
Construction	
Ball-cap & Ring	Missing.
Handle	Wooden core not at least 1/4 inch in diameter. Wooden core not extended into handle at least 1 inch. Not well wound with wire to the minimum required by table I.
Broom body	Minimum number of rows & minimum number of stitches per row, not as required by table I.
Dimensions	
Completed whisk broom	Any dimensional difference from that established by table I.

4.3.2.2 Inspection of preparation for delivery. An inspection shall be made to determine that the packaging, packing and marking comply with the requirements in section 5 of this specification. Defects shall be scored in accordance with the following list. For examination of interior packaging the sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery, selected at random just prior to the closing operations. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. Defects of closure listed shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 with an acceptable quality level (AQL) of 2.5 defects per hundred units.

TABLE III. Preparation for delivery examination.

Examine	Defects
Markings (exterior and interior)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Materials	Any component missing or damaged.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as incomplete closure of container flaps, loose strapping, inadequate stapling. Distortion of container.
Contents (exterior and interior container)	Number per container is more or less than required. Net weight exceeds requirements.

4.4 Tests.

4.4.1 Strength of twine. Strength tests shall be made on twine removed from the broom by the single-strand method on a pendulum (enclined balance) type machine having smooth grips of the drum type, not less than 1-1/4 inches in diameter. The drums on which the load is applied shall move at a uniform rate of 12 inches ± 2 inches, per minute. The distance between the centers of the drums shall not be less than 10 inches. If for any reason attributable to faulty operation the result falls markedly below the average of the set, the result shall be disregarded and another specimen shall be broken. At least two specimens shall be broken and the results averaged. The twine tested shall be examined for compliance with 3.3.3.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:06Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.4.2 Corrosion test. Completed parts when fabricated of ferrous metal shall be placed in a boiling 10 percent (by weight) aqueous solution of sodium chloride for a period of not less than 15 minutes. The part upon being removed from the solution shall be immediately immersed for at least one hour in a 10 percent (by weight) aqueous solution of sodium chloride at room temperature of 68 to 85 degrees F. The part shall then be removed from this solution and without having the adhering liquid wiped off, allowed to dry for at least 24 hours at room temperature 68 to 85 degrees F., and wiped free of any residue and examined for presence of corrosion. Examine parts for compliance with 3.3.2 and 3.3.2.1.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.1).

5.1.1 Level A and B. Twelve whisk brooms shall be packaged in a compact bundle and securely tied or wrapped.

5.1.2 Level C. Whisk brooms shall be packaged in accordance with the suppliers commercial practice.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.1).

5.2.1 Level A. Unit bundles shall be packed in a box conforming to PPP-B-636, class weather resistant. The box shall be closed, waterproofed, and strapped, in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.2.2 Level B. Twelve unit bundles shall be packed in a box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic. The box shall be closed in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.2.3 Level C. Whisk brooms shall be packed to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination at the lowest rates, in containers complying with the rules and regulations applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Civil agencies. In addition to markings required by the contract or purchase order, the unit bundle and shipping container shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.3.2 Military activities. In addition to markings required by the contract or purchase order, the unit bundle and shipping container shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES.

6.1 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents.

(a) Title, number and date of this specification.
(b) When preproduction sample is required (see 3.1).
(c) Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:06Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.



FIGURE 1

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:06Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.